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TRANSPORTATION



Foxconn sells former GM factory to mystery buyer after failing to make EVs

Foxconn has sold the former GM factory it has owned for three years after failing to stand up any meaningful, large-scale electric vehicle production here.

The pivot marks the second major failure of Foxconn to deliver on its promises to help revive U.S. manufacturing. The iPhone-maker once promised to build a giant LCD factory in Wisconsin — a project that Donald Trump called the “eighth wonder of the world” during his first term — and wound up underdelivering to an extreme degree.

Foxconn says the buyer is an “existing business partner”

named “Crescent” in Delaware, just outside the state. Matt Dewine says more about

Foxconn sold machinery and equipment for \$287 million, IMAGE

A Foxconn representative will remain “committed” to customers and the industry. But the Wall Street Journal reported Monday that

Foxconn now plans to build AI servers at the factory. Dewine did not immediately respond to a request for comment on the report.

Foxconn announced the deal to buy the former GM plant in 2021 for \$230 million, when it was still owned by EV startup Lordstown Motors. At the time, Foxconn Chairman Young Liu said it was going to be the “most important electric vehicle manufacturing and R&D hub in North America.”

While Foxconn was developing EVs of its own in Asia, it was also focused on contract manufacturing in the United States. And, in short order, three of the electric vehicle companies Foxconn hoped would occupy the factory went bankrupt.

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A fourth company, Monarch Tractor, has not had much of an impact, with Foxconn making no more than a few hundred electric tractors. Monarch's CEO, Praveen Penmetsa, did not respond to an emailed request for comment about whether its tractors will continue to be built in Ohio.

Topics: [electric vehicles](#) [EVs](#) [Foxconn](#) [Transportation](#)



Sean O'Kane

Sr. Reporter, Transportation | [X](#)

Sean O'Kane is a reporter who has spent a decade covering the rapidly-evolving business and technology of the transportation...

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MEGAN JELINGER / AFP / GETTY IMAGES

EV startup Lordstown Motors made headlines when it purchased a 6.2 million-square-foot factory from General Motors in 2019. Now, it looks like the strapped-for-cash startup will likely sell that facility to Taiwan's Foxconn Technology Group.

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manufacturing expertise.

Foxconn, though best known for manufacturing Apple’s iPhone, has made major strides to enter the electric vehicle manufacturing market over the past few years. The company has inked deals with [EV startup Fisker](#) to co-develop and manufacture a new electric vehicle, and Foxconn will also start manufacturing up to 50,000 vehicles at a Thailand factory in partnership with [Thai oil supplier PTT PLC](#).

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[Foxconn, Geely team up to build electric, autonomous and shared vehicles for automakers](#)

Lordstown is aiming to deliver the first models of its flagship electric truck “Endurance” to a small group of customers early next year. The company named a new chief executive in

August, after [former CEO Steve Burns resigned](#) following concerns over the company's coffers. CEO Dan Ninivaggi was instated scarcely a year after Lordstown announced its \$1.6 billion SPAC merger.

At their 52-week highs, Lordstown shares hit \$31.80 apiece. They're now trading at \$7.88.

TechCrunch has reached out to Lordstown and Foxconn for comment and will update the story if they respond.

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Foxconn will build EVs for Lordstown Motors and Fisker at Ohio plant

Kirsten Korosec · 4:56 PM PDT · September 30, 2021

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square-foot factory. Lordstown purchased the factory in 2019 from General Motors.

Under the agreement, which has yet to close, Foxconn will pay \$230 million for the facility. The deal excludes certain assets such as Lordstown's hub motor assembly line, battery module and packing line assets and certain intellectual property rights. Foxconn will also buy \$50 million of Lordstown common stock.

The companies said they will negotiate a contract manufacturing agreement for Foxconn to assemble Lordstown's Endurance full-size pickup truck at the facility. Reaching a contract manufacturing agreement is a condition to closing the facility purchase. The parties have agreed to

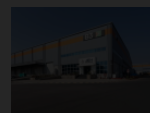
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explore licensing arrangements for additional pickup truck programs.

The deal comes at a critical moment for Lordstown Motors, a cash-strapped startup turned SPAC that had a string of missteps earlier this year. In August, the company [hired Daniel A. Ninivaggi](#), a longtime automotive executive and former head of Carl C. Icahn's holding company, as CEO and a board member. The appointment came after months of tumult at the company, including the resignation of its founder and CEO [Steve Burns](#). CFO [Julio Rodriguez](#) [resigned](#) following a disappointing first-quarter earnings report that revealed the company was consuming more capital than expected and unable to reach previously [forecasted production numbers](#) for its electric Endurance pickup truck.

The goal of the partnership, the companies said in its

announcement.

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tp begin in the U.S. by the end of 2020 and will then ramp up

into the following year, Fisker told TechCrunch in an [an August interview](#).

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Fisker didn't reveal the U.S. manufacturing location. The final decision would be Foxconn's, Fisker noted at the time.

Fisker issued a statement Thursday welcoming the news from Foxconn.

"Achieving key program objectives such as time to market, access to a well-developed supplier ecosystem and overall cost targets were all important factors in the decision to locate manufacturing in Ohio," Henrik Fisker said in an emailed statement. "Since signing the agreement with Foxconn earlier this year, we have been working together intensively on all aspects of Project PEAR including design, engineering, manufacturing and testing. Fisker's commitment to the U.S. market is a key part of this agreement."

Fisker also has announced plans to assemble different components of the car in different locations. The car is expected to be assembled by Lordstown Motors in Steyr in Europe. Production is expected to begin in November 2023. The car is expected to be a second-quality vehicle, meaning it will be sold at a discount and the United States. The car is expected to be produced in production of the car is expected to begin in 2023.

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Kirsten Korosec is a reporter and editor who has covered the future of transportation from EVs and autonomous vehicles to urban air mobility...

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